

Bosonization of Majorana CFT with Boundaries

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Abstract

This is my own note on the topic of Majorana CFT and Ising CFT with boundaries.

Contents

1	Preliminaries 1: Ising CFT and BCFT	3
1.1	Lightning Review of BCFT	3
1.1.1	Gluing Condition	3
1.1.2	Boundary States Formalism	3
1.1.3	Cardy's Condition	4
1.1.4	Elementary Boundary States	5
1.2	Ising CFT	6
1.2.1	Ising CFT Data	6
1.2.2	Virasoro Characters of Ising CFT	6
1.2.3	Modular S Matrix and Transformation of Characters	7
1.3	Ising BCFT	7
1.3.1	Ishibashi States of Ising BCFT	7
1.3.2	Cardy States of Ising BCFT	8
1.3.3	Partition Functions of Ising BCFT	8
2	Preliminaries 2: Majorana CFT	8
2.1	Majorana CFT Path Integral Formalism	9
2.1.1	Action and Equations of Motion	9
2.1.2	Energy-Momentum Tensor	9
2.1.3	OPE Structure	9
2.2	Majorana CFT Canonical Formalism	9
2.2.1	Quantization and Mode Expansion	9
2.2.2	Neveu-Schwarz and Ramond Sectors	10
2.2.3	Hamiltonian after Normalization	10
2.2.4	Zero Mode and Ground State Degeneracy	11
2.2.5	Fermion Parity	11
2.2.6	Hilbert Space Structure	12
2.3	Majorana CFT on a Cylinder	12
2.3.1	Conformal Transformation to Cylinder	12
2.3.2	Hamiltonian on a Cylinder	13
2.3.3	Conformal Transformation to Cylinder (another convention)	13
2.3.4	Hamiltonian on a Cylinder (another convention)	14

3	Majorana BCFT	15
3.1	Boundary Conditions of Majorana CFT	15
3.1.1	Boundary Conditions on UHP	15
3.1.2	Boundary Conditions on General Manifold	15
3.1.3	Boundary Conditions on a Strip	15
3.2	Open Channel Partition Function	16
3.2.1	Doubling Trick	16
3.2.2	Canonical Quantization	17
3.2.3	Zero Mode and Ground State Degeneracy(?)	18
3.2.4	Boundary Fermion	18
3.2.5	Fermion Parity Operator	20
3.2.6	0A Theory and 0B Theory	20
3.2.7	Open Channel Hilbert Space	20
3.2.8	Open Channel Partition Functions	21
3.3	Closed Channel Partition Function	23
3.3.1	Fermionic Boundary State Formalism	23
3.3.2	Canonical Quantization in Closed Channel	23
3.3.3	Gluing Conditions and Ishibashi States	24
3.3.4	Boundary States and Partition Functions	26
4	Bosonization of Majorana BCFT	28
4.1	GSO Projection and $\mathbb{Z}_2$ Orbifold	28
4.1.1	GSO Projection	28
4.1.2	Bosonization with boundaries	28
4.2	Closed channel Bosonization	28
4.2.1	Fermionic Parity and 0A/0B Theories	29
4.2.2	GSO Projection of Boundary States	29
4.2.3	Final Bosonized Boundary States	29
4.3	Compare with Exact Partition Function Calculation	31
4.3.1	Boundary States	31

1 Preliminaries 1: Ising CFT and BCFT

1.1 Lightning Review of BCFT

I will first give a very brief review of fundamental concepts and tools in Boundary Conformal Field Theory (BCFT). For a more detailed introduction, one can refer to my CFT and BCFT note [12, 11], [click here](#), and the following references [2, 9, 10], these three references are found to be most helpful for my understanding of BCFT.

1.1.1 Gluing Condition

A Boundary CFT (BCFT) is a conformal field theory on a manifold with boundary induced from a parent CFT. It inherits the operator algebra data of the parent CFT, while having extra data due to the presence of boundaries. The simplest case is to consider a BCFT on the upper half plane (UHP) $\{z = x + iy | y \geq 0\}$, where the real axis $y = 0$ serves as the boundary.

To preserve conformal symmetry at the boundary, we need to impose the so-called gluing condition on the energy-momentum tensor $T(z)$ and $\bar{T}(\bar{z})$ at the boundary:

Definition 1. *Gluing Condition*

At the boundary $y = 0$, the energy-momentum tensor satisfies:

$$T(z) = \bar{T}(\bar{z}) \quad \text{at } y = 0. \quad (1)$$

With this gluing condition, we can prove that the conformal symmetry is "partially" preserved, which leads to the existence of a single Virasoro algebra instead of two independent ones:

Theorem 1. *Symmetry Algebra of BCFT*

In a BCFT defined on the upper half plane with the gluing condition $T(z) = \bar{T}(\bar{z})$ at the boundary $y = 0$, the symmetry algebra is generated by a single Virasoro algebra with generators:

$$L_n^H = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_C dz z^{n+1} T^H(z) \quad (2)$$

where $T^H(z)$ is the analytical continuation of $T(z)$ and $\bar{T}(\bar{z})$. Satisfying:

$$[L_n^H, L_m^H] = (n - m)L_{n+m}^H + \frac{c}{12}n(n^2 - 1)\delta_{n+m,0} \quad (3)$$

1.1.2 Boundary States Formalism

There exist various ways of defining a BCFT from a parent CFT on a manifold by imposing different types of boundary conditions at the boundary. A tool of labeling and classifying these boundary conditions is the boundary state formalism. We define the boundary states as;

Definition 2. *Boundary State*

Boundary states $|\alpha\rangle$ and $|\beta\rangle$ are defined as states living on the boundary of the parent CFT placed on a chopped cylinder, and they satisfy:

- *The cylinder has the same geometry as a compactified BCFT on a strip, with length L and circumference β .*

- The partition function of the parent CFT on a cylinder with boundary states $|\alpha\rangle$ and $|\beta\rangle$ at its two ends is equivalent to the partition function of the BCFT on a strip with boundary conditions α and β at the two ends. Mathematically:

$$Z_{\alpha\beta} = \langle \alpha | \tilde{q}^{\frac{1}{2}(L_0 + \bar{L}_0 - c/12)} | \beta \rangle = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{\alpha\beta}} \left(q^{L_0^H - c/24} \right), \quad (4)$$

where $q = e^{-\pi\beta/L}$ and $\tilde{q} = e^{-4\pi L/\beta}$. Here L_0 and $\bar{L}_0$ are the Virasoro generators of the parent CFT, while L_0^H is the Virasoro generator in the BCFT.

We can use the boundary states as a state in the Hilbert space of the parent CFT to encode the boundary conditions of the BCFT. To be consistent with the gluing condition, the boundary states must satisfy the following Ishibashi condition:

Theorem 2. Ishibashi Condition

Boundary states $|\alpha\rangle$ should satisfy:

$$(L_n - \bar{L}_{-n}) |\alpha\rangle = 0, \quad \forall n \in \mathbb{Z}. \quad (5)$$

A solution to the Ishibashi condition can be constructed from each primary state $|h\rangle$ of the parent CFT, leading to the definition of Ishibashi states:

Definition 3. Ishibashi State

For each primary state $|h\rangle$ of the parent CFT, the corresponding Ishibashi state $|h\rangle\rangle$ is defined as:

$$|h\rangle\rangle = \sum_N |h; N\rangle \otimes \overline{|h; N\rangle}, \quad (6)$$

where $\{|h; N\rangle\}$ is an orthonormal basis of the Verma module built on the chiral primary state $|h\rangle$.

We can prove that the Ishibashi States satisfy the Ishibashi Conditions.

1.1.3 Cardy's Condition

Consider the Parent CFT as a diagonal CFT. Indeed the main topic of the note Ising CFT is a diagonal CFT. There exist another consistency condition for the boundary state:

Theorem 3. Cardy's Condition

For two boundary states $|\alpha\rangle$ and β they should satisfy that:

$$\sum_h \langle \alpha | h \rangle \langle h | \beta \rangle S_h^{h'} = n_{\alpha\beta}^{h'} \quad \text{or equivalently} \quad \langle a | h' \rangle \langle h' | b \rangle = \sum_h S_h^{h'} n_{ab}^h. \quad (7)$$

where $S_h^{h'}$ is the modular S matrix of the parent CFT and $n_{\alpha\beta}^{h'}$ are non-negative integers representing the multiplicities of the representation with highest weight h' in the open channel partition function $Z_{\alpha\beta}$.

Proof: see Cardy's original paper [2].

If we assume that the boundary states are linear combination of Ishibashi States, we can also write the Cardy's condition a relation of expansion coefficients:

Theorem 4. Cardy's Condition (coefficient constrain)

Consider the boundary states written as:

$$|a\rangle = \sum_i B_i^a |i\rangle \rangle \quad (8)$$

The Cardy's condition says that:

$$\sum_{ij} B_i^{a*} B_i^b S_i^j \chi_j(q) = \sum_i n_{ab}^i \chi_i(q) \quad \Rightarrow \quad \sum_i B_i^{a*} B_i^b S_i^j = n_{ab}^j \quad (9)$$

where χ_i is the character of the Virasoro representation.

A solution to the Cardy's condition is given by comparing it with the Verlinder formula. These solutions are called the Cardy States:

Definition 4. Cardy States

Cardy states are linear combination of Ishibashi states with coefficients given by:

$$|a\rangle = \sum_j \frac{S_a^j}{(S_0^j)^{1/2}} |j\rangle \rangle \quad (10)$$

Proof: taking n_{ab}^i as the fusion matrix N_{bc}^a and Cardy states into Cardy's condition, we can see that the Cardy's condition theorem 4 is exactly the Verlinder formula.

1.1.4 Elementary Boundary States

Looking at the Cardy's condition we might see that, if a state $|a\rangle$ satisfy the condition then $\mathbb{N}_+ |a\rangle$ must also satisfy this condition, for we only insist n_{ab}^i to be non-negative integers.

However, we usually only consider the so-called elementary boundary states that can not be decomposed into a sum of other boundary states. Thus we have the definition:

Definition 5. Elementary Boundary States

For a parent CFT, a induced BCFT have following elementary boundary states $\{|a_i\rangle\}$ that shall satisfy the following normalization and orthogonality condition:

$$n_{a_i a_j}^0 = \delta_{ij} \quad (11)$$

The normalization is physical, this is because for a field theory, we assume to have a unique vacuum state, thus if $n_{ab}^0 \geq 2$ we will have multiple vacuum states in the open channel, which is unphysical, and shall be interpret as putting two identical theory together. Our goal is to find all elementary boundary states of a BCFT induced from a parent CFT.

Moreover, we can see that

Theorem 5. *Cardy states are elementary boundary states.*

This is because, cardy's state is a solution when considering $n_{ab}^i = N_{ab}^i$ which is the bulk fusion matrix. And we know that according to the 2 point function of bulk primary fields, the vacuum representation only appear once in the fusion of two primary fields when they are the same, written in operator algebra as:

$$\phi_a \times \phi_b = \mathbb{1}\delta_{ab} + \dots \quad (12)$$

1.2 Ising CFT

Ising CFT as the simplest unitary minimal model $M(3/4)$ with central charge $c = 1/2$. Here I will briefly review some basic data of Ising CFT that will be used in the following sections. For a more detailed introduction to Ising CFT, one can refer to [4].

1.2.1 Ising CFT Data

Ising CFT is the simplest A-series unitary minimal model $M(3, 4)$ with central charge $c = \frac{1}{2}$. It has three primary fields:

- Identity operator $\mathbb{1}$ with conformal weights $h_{\mathbb{1}} = \bar{h}_{\mathbb{1}} = 0$,
- Spin operator σ with conformal weights $h_{\sigma} = \bar{h}_{\sigma} = \frac{1}{16}$
- Energy operator ϵ with conformal weights $h_{\epsilon} = \bar{h}_{\epsilon} = \frac{1}{2}$.

They satisfy the following operator algebra (fusion rules):

$$\sigma \times \sigma = \mathbb{1} + \epsilon, \quad (13)$$

$$\sigma \times \epsilon = \sigma, \quad (14)$$

$$\epsilon \times \epsilon = \mathbb{1}. \quad (15)$$

1.2.2 Virasoro Characters of Ising CFT

Characters of a Virasoro Representation is defined as :

Definition 6. Character

The character $\chi_h(q)$ of a Virasoro representation with highest weight h is defined as:

$$\chi_h(q) = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_h} \left(q^{L_0 - c/24} \right), \quad (16)$$

For Ising CFT the characters of the three primary fields are given by:

$$\chi_0(q) = \frac{1}{2} q^{-\frac{1}{48}} \left(\prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 + q^{\frac{1}{2}+n} \right) + \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 - q^{\frac{1}{2}+n} \right) \right), \quad (17)$$

$$\chi_{1/2}(q) = \frac{1}{2} q^{-\frac{1}{48}} \left(\prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 + q^{\frac{1}{2}+n} \right) - \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 - q^{\frac{1}{2}+n} \right) \right), \quad (18)$$

$$\chi_{1/16}(q) = q^{\frac{1}{24}} \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} (1 + q^n) \quad (19)$$

1.2.3 Modular S Matrix and Transformation of Characters

The modular S Matrix of Ising CFT is given by:

$$S_j^i = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{2} & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (20)$$

with the column and row order $1, \epsilon, \sigma$. The characters form a representation of the modular group with the transformation:

$$\chi_i(q) = \sum_j S_i^j \chi_j(\tilde{q}). \quad (21)$$

if we take $q = e^{-\frac{\pi\beta}{L}}$ and $\tilde{q} = e^{-\frac{4\pi L}{\beta}}$, we have:

$$\chi_0(\tilde{q}) = \frac{1}{2} (\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \chi_{1/16}(q), \quad (22)$$

$$\chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}) = \frac{1}{2} (\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \chi_{1/16}(q), \quad (23)$$

$$\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q}) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (\chi_0(q) - \chi_{1/2}(q)). \quad (24)$$

as well as the inverse transformation:

$$\chi_0(q) = \frac{1}{2} (\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q}), \quad (25)$$

$$\chi_{1/2}(q) = \frac{1}{2} (\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q}), \quad (26)$$

$$\chi_{1/16}(q) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (\chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})). \quad (27)$$

Remark: For Ising CFT the modular S matrix is self-inverse, i.e. $S = S^{-1}$.

1.3 Ising BCFT

For a BCFT induced from Ising CFT, we can construct its boundary states by solving the Ishibashi condition and the Cardy's condition.

1.3.1 Ishibashi States of Ising BCFT

The Ishibashi states of Ising CFT can be constructed from its three primary states:

Definition 7. *Ising Ishibashi States*

Ising CFT has three Ishibashi states:

$$|0\rangle\rangle = \sum_N |0; N\rangle \otimes \overline{|0; N\rangle}, \quad (28)$$

$$|1/2\rangle\rangle = \sum_N |1/2; N\rangle \otimes \overline{|1/2; N\rangle}, \quad (29)$$

$$|1/16\rangle\rangle = \sum_N |1/16; N\rangle \otimes \overline{|1/16; N\rangle}. \quad (30)$$

1.3.2 Cardy States of Ising BCFT

Using the modular S matrix of Ising CFT, we can write down the Cardy states by definition:

Definition 8. *Ising Cardy States*

Ising BCFT exist three Cardy states:

$$|+\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|0\rangle + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|1/2\rangle + \frac{1}{\sqrt[4]{2}}|1/16\rangle \quad (31)$$

$$|-\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|0\rangle + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}|1/2\rangle - \frac{1}{\sqrt[4]{2}}|1/16\rangle \quad (32)$$

$$|f\rangle = |0\rangle - |1/2\rangle. \quad (33)$$

In Cardy's original paper [2], these three boundary states are argued to correspond to the three physical boundary conditions of the Ising model¹:

- $|+\rangle$: fixed boundary condition with spins fixed to +1 at the boundary.
- $|-\rangle$: fixed boundary condition with spins fixed to -1 at the boundary.
- $|f\rangle$: free boundary condition with spins free to fluctuate at the boundary.

1.3.3 Partition Functions of Ising BCFT

With the Cardy states, we can compute the partition functions of Ising BCFT on a compactified strip (cylinder) with different boundary conditions:

Partition Function	Close Channel	Expression in $\tilde{q}$	Expression in q
$Z_{++} = Z_{--}$	$\langle \pm \tilde{q}^{\frac{1}{2}(L_0 + \bar{L}_0 - c/12)} \pm \rangle$	$\frac{1}{2}\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \frac{1}{2}\chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$	$\chi_0(q)$
$Z_{+-} = Z_{-+}$	$\langle \pm \tilde{q}^{\frac{1}{2}(L_0 + \bar{L}_0 - c/12)} \mp \rangle$	$\frac{1}{2}\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \frac{1}{2}\chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$	$\chi_{1/2}(q)$
$Z_{+f} = Z_{-f}$	$\langle \pm \tilde{q}^{\frac{1}{2}(L_0 + \bar{L}_0 - c/12)} f \rangle$	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})$	$\chi_{1/16}(q)$
Z_{ff}	$\langle f \tilde{q}^{\frac{1}{2}(L_0 + \bar{L}_0 - c/12)} f \rangle$	$\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})$	$\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)$

Table 1: Partition function and corresponding characters in both $\tilde{q}$ and q expansions.

We can see that the expression in q always have non-negative integer coefficients, which satisfy the Cardy condition.

2 Preliminaries 2: Majorana CFT

A Majorana CFT exhibits a Lagrangian description. In this section, I will briefly review the Majorana CFT. A detailed introduction can be found in [4, 6]. Note that I take the idea of the reference [6] to quantize the theory on a complex plane first and then transform it to a cylinder. But I appreciate the convention of the reference [4].

¹this is an argument made by considering the transformation of the boundary states under $\mathbb{Z}_2$ symmetry of Ising CFT. It is not a rigorous theorem.

2.1 Majorana CFT Path Integral Formalism

2.1.1 Action and Equations of Motion

The action of a free Majorana fermion on a complex plane is given by:

Definition 9. Majorana Fermion Action

The action of a free Majorana fermion $\psi(z)$ and $\bar{\psi}(\bar{z})$ on a complex plane is given by:

$$S = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int d^2z (\psi \bar{\partial} \psi + \bar{\psi} \partial \bar{\psi}), \quad (34)$$

where $\partial = \frac{\partial}{\partial z}$ and $\bar{\partial} = \frac{\partial}{\partial \bar{z}}$ and $d^2z = d^2x = dx dy$.

In this convention, the equations of motion derived from the action are:

$$\bar{\partial} \psi(z) = 0, \quad \partial \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) = 0, \quad (35)$$

which means that $\psi(z)$ is a holomorphic field and $\bar{\psi}(\bar{z})$ is an anti-holomorphic field.

2.1.2 Energy-Momentum Tensor

With the standard convention, we calculate the E-M tensor from the action:

$$T(z) = -2\pi T_{zz}(z) = -\frac{1}{2} \psi(z) \partial \psi(z), \quad \bar{T}(\bar{z}) = -2\pi T_{\bar{z}\bar{z}}(\bar{z}) = -\frac{1}{2} \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) \bar{\partial} \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}). \quad (36)$$

Remark: Note that the definition of $T(z)$ has different conventions. But it is due to different conventions of the action and the field. We here take the convention in the reference [4].

2.1.3 OPE Structure

The OPE structure of the Majorana fermion fields can be derived from their two-point correlation functions:

$$\langle \psi(z) \psi(w) \rangle = \frac{1}{z-w} \quad \langle \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) \bar{\psi}(\bar{w}) \rangle = \frac{1}{\bar{z}-\bar{w}} \quad (37)$$

$$\langle \psi(z) \bar{\psi}(\bar{w}) \rangle = 0 \quad (38)$$

Thus we have the following OPEs:

$$\psi(z) \psi(w) \sim \frac{1}{z-w}, \quad \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) \bar{\psi}(\bar{w}) \sim \frac{1}{\bar{z}-\bar{w}}, \quad \psi(z) \bar{\psi}(\bar{w}) \sim 0. \quad (39)$$

2.2 Majorana CFT Canonical Formalism

2.2.1 Quantization and Mode Expansion

We then consider the radial quantization of the theory on a complex plane. The EoM gives us that the fields can be expanded as:

$$\psi(z) = \sum_k b_k z^{-k-1/2} \quad \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) = \sum_k \bar{b}_k \bar{z}^{-k-1/2} \quad (40)$$

it is a common convention to take the $z^{1/2}$ in the mode expansion. The OPE of the fields gives us the anti-commutation relations of the modes:

$$\{b_k, b_l\} = \delta_{k+l,0}, \quad \{\bar{b}_k, \bar{b}_l\} = \delta_{k+l,0}, \quad \{b_k, \bar{b}_l\} = 0. \quad (41)$$

Moreover the Majorana fermion condition $\psi(z) = \psi^\dagger(z)$ gives us that the modes satisfy:

$$b_k^\dagger = b_{-k}, \quad \bar{b}_k^\dagger = \bar{b}_{-k}. \quad (42)$$

The E-M tensor can also be expanded in modes:

$$T(z) = -\frac{1}{2} : \psi(z) \partial \psi(z) : = \sum_n L_n z^{-n-2}, \quad \bar{T}(\bar{z}) = -\frac{1}{2} : \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) \bar{\partial} \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) : = \sum_n \bar{L}_n \bar{z}^{-n-2}, \quad (43)$$

Remark: We shall note that the quantum version of the E-M tensor we impose normal ordering as a convention. Here we take the convention that the modes with positive index are annihilation operators and the modes with negative index are creation operators.

The virasoro generator of the theory are thus explicitly given by:

$$L_n = \frac{1}{2} \sum_k (k + \frac{1}{2}) : b_{n-k} b_k : \quad (44)$$

2.2.2 Neveu-Schwarz and Ramond Sectors

We then notice a subtlety in the theory. We can impose two different boundary conditions on the fermion fields when we consider the theory on a cylinder:

- **Neveu-Schwarz (NS) Boundary Condition:**

$$\psi(e^{2\pi i} z) = \psi(z), \quad \bar{\psi}(e^{-2\pi i} \bar{z}) = \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}). \quad (45)$$

This boundary condition leads to half-integer moding of the fermion fields:

$$k \in \mathbb{Z} + \frac{1}{2}. \quad (46)$$

- **Ramond (R) Boundary Condition:**

$$\psi(e^{2\pi i} z) = -\psi(z), \quad \bar{\psi}(e^{-2\pi i} \bar{z}) = -\bar{\psi}(\bar{z}). \quad (47)$$

This boundary condition leads to integer moding of the fermion fields:

$$k \in \mathbb{Z}. \quad (48)$$

Thus different boundary conditions lead to different mode expansions of the fermion fields as well as different Hilbert spaces of the theory. The Hilbert space of the theory is thus classified into two sectors: the NS sector and the R sector.

2.2.3 Hamiltonian after Normalization

The Hamiltonian of the theory on a complex plane is given by the generator of the time translation:

Theorem 6. Majorana CFT Hamiltonian on a Complex Plane

The Hamiltonian of the Majorana CFT on a complex plane is given by:

$$H = L_0 + \bar{L}_0 \quad (49)$$

$$L_0 = \sum_{k>0} k b_{-k} b_k, \quad \bar{L}_0 = \sum_{k>0} k \bar{b}_{-k} \bar{b}_k, \quad (\text{NS} : k \in \mathbb{Z} + \frac{1}{2}) \quad (50)$$

$$L_0 = \sum_{k>0} k b_{-k} b_k + \frac{1}{16}, \quad \bar{L}_0 = \sum_{k>0} k \bar{b}_{-k} \bar{b}_k + \frac{1}{16}, \quad (\text{R} : k \in \mathbb{Z}) \quad (51)$$

Note that we have minus a constant in both sector to set the ground state energy of the NS sector to zero.

Remark: Both calculations of the sectors gives a infinite vaccum enegery: $1/2 \sum_{k=1}^{\infty} k = -1/24$ for NS and $1/2 \sum_{k=0}^{\infty} (k+1/2) = 1/48$. We regulate the vaccum energy by adding $1/24$, thus we get 0 in the NS sector and $1/16$ in the R sector.

2.2.4 Zero Mode and Ground State Degeneracy

The NS sector works straightforwardly with a zero vacuum energy after normalization and a unique ground state $|0\rangle_{NS}$ defined by:

$$b_k |0\rangle_{NS} = 0, \quad \bar{b}_k |0\rangle_{NS} = 0, \quad k > 0. \quad (52)$$

However, the R sector is more subtle due to the presence of zero modes b_0 and $\bar{b}_0$. These zero modes satisfy the Clifford algebra:

$$\{b_0, b_0\} = 1, \quad \{\bar{b}_0, \bar{b}_0\} = 1, \quad \{b_0, \bar{b}_0\} = 0. \quad (53)$$

We can see that the zero modes b_0 and $\bar{b}_0$ generate a two-dimensional representation of the Clifford algebra. Thus the ground state of the R sector is doubly degenerate according to the following theorem:

Theorem 7. *Two dimensional Clifford Algebra Representation have non-trivial representation for at least two dimensions.*

Thus, we can define two ground states $|+\rangle_R$ and $|-\rangle_R$ and the act of pauli matrix on it is:

$$\sigma_x |\pm\rangle_R = |\mp\rangle_R, \quad \sigma_y |\pm\rangle_R = \mp i |\mp\rangle_R, \quad \sigma_z |\pm\rangle_R = \pm |\pm\rangle_R. \quad (54)$$

And then we can represent the zero modes and the fermion parity operator as:

$$b_0 = \frac{1}{2} (\sigma_x + \sigma_y) (-1)^{\sum_{n>0} b_{-n} b_n + \bar{b}_{-n} \bar{b}_n}, \quad (55)$$

$$\bar{b}_0 = \frac{1}{2} (\sigma_x - \sigma_y) (-1)^{\sum_{n>0} b_{-n} b_n + \bar{b}_{-n} \bar{b}_n}, \quad (56)$$

$$(57)$$

In this convention, we have:

$$b_0 |\pm\rangle_R = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} e^{\pm i\pi/4} |\mp\rangle_R, \quad \bar{b}_0 |\pm\rangle_R = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} e^{\mp i\pi/4} |\mp\rangle_R. \quad (58)$$

2.2.5 Fermion Parity

We hope to define (in many cases this operator might not be well defined) the fermion parity operator $(-1)^F$ in the Majorana CFT as follows:

Definition 10. Fermion Parity Operator

The fermion number operator F in a Majorana CFT is defined as:

$$\{(-1)^F, b_k\} = 0, \quad \{(-1)^F, \bar{b}_k\} = 0, \quad \text{for all } k, \quad (59)$$

[note] In the NS sector, the fermion parity operator is explicitly given by:

$$(-1)^F = (-1)^{\sum_{k>0} b_{-k} b_k + \sum_{k>0} \bar{b}_{-k} \bar{b}_k}. \quad (60)$$

However, in the R sector defining the fermion number operator is more subtle. There are two different ways of defining the fermion number operator in the R sector, write it in terms of $b_0, \bar{b}_0$:

$$(-1)^F = \begin{cases} -2i b_0 \bar{b}_0 (-1)^{F_{nz}}, & \text{type 0A} \\ +2i b_0 \bar{b}_0 (-1)^{F_{nz}}. & \text{type 0B} \end{cases} \quad (61)$$

In string theory, they are called type 0A and type 0B. Commonly, we take the notation of $(-1)^{F_{nz}} = (-1)^{\sum_{k>0} b_{-k} b_k + \sum_{k>0} \bar{b}_{-k} \bar{b}_k}$ non-zero mode fermion parity operator.

[I'm not sure about do I understand this correctly.]

2.2.6 Hilbert Space Structure

With the ground state structure and mode expansion, we can construct the Hilbert space of the Majorana CFT. The Hilbert space is classified into two sectors: the NS sector and the R sector.

- **NS Sector Hilbert Space:** The Hilbert space in the NS sector is constructed by acting the creation operators $b_{-k}, \bar{b}_{-k}$ ($k > 0$ and $k \in \mathbb{Z} + 1/2$) on the unique ground state $|0\rangle_{NS}$:

$$\mathcal{H}_{NS} = \text{span} \left\{ b_{-k_1} b_{-k_2} \cdots \bar{b}_{-l_1} \bar{b}_{-l_2} \cdots |0\rangle_{NS} \mid k_i, l_j > 0, k_i, l_j \in \mathbb{Z} + \frac{1}{2} \right\}. \quad (62)$$

- **R Sector Hilbert Space:** The Hilbert space in the R sector is constructed by acting the creation operators $b_{-k}, \bar{b}_{-k}$ ($k > 0$ and $k \in \mathbb{Z}$) on the doubly degenerate ground states $|\pm\rangle_R$:

$$\mathcal{H}_R = \text{span} \left\{ b_{-k_1} b_{-k_2} \cdots \bar{b}_{-l_1} \bar{b}_{-l_2} \cdots |\pm\rangle_R \mid k_i, l_j > 0, k_i, l_j \in \mathbb{Z} \right\}. \quad (63)$$

2.3 Majorana CFT on a Cylinder

Here we will consider the theory on a cylinder with circumference β . As we do in CFT, we map the theory from a complex plane to a cylinder via a conformal map.

2.3.1 Conformal Transformation to Cylinder

We then transform the theory from a complex plane to a cylinder with circumference β via the conformal map:

$$w = \frac{\beta}{2\pi} \ln z, \quad \bar{w} = \frac{\beta}{2\pi} \ln \bar{z} \quad z = e^{\frac{2\pi w}{\beta}}, \quad \bar{z} = e^{\frac{2\pi \bar{w}}{\beta}} \quad (64)$$

$$w = t - i\sigma, \quad \bar{w} = t + i\sigma, \quad \sigma \in [-\beta, 0] \quad (65)$$

Under this map the fermion fields transform as:

$$\psi^C(w) = \left(\frac{dz}{dw} \right)^{1/2} \psi(z) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{\beta} z \right)^{1/2} \psi(z), \quad (66)$$

$$\bar{\psi}^C(\bar{w}) = \left(\frac{d\bar{z}}{d\bar{w}} \right)^{1/2} \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{\beta} \bar{z} \right)^{1/2} \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}). \quad (67)$$

The mode expansion on a cylinder is thus given by:

$$\psi^C(w) = \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{\beta}} \sum_k b_k e^{-2\pi k w / \beta} \quad \bar{\psi}^C(\bar{w}) = \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{\beta}} \sum_k \bar{b}_k e^{-2\pi k \bar{w} / \beta} \quad (68)$$

the mode b_k is exactly the same object as that on the complex plane.

Remark: It is interesting to note that the NS boundary condition becomes antiperiodic boundary condition on the cylinder; while the R boundary condition becomes periodic boundary condition on the cylinder. Thus, it is ambiguous to call a boundary condition antiperiodic or periodic without specifying the geometry.

The E-M tensor on a cylinder is given by:

$$T^C(w) = \left(\frac{dz}{dw}\right)^2 T(z) + \frac{c}{12}\{z, w\} = \left(\frac{2\pi}{\beta}\right)^2 \left(z^2 T(z) - \frac{1}{48}\right), \quad (69)$$

$$\bar{T}^C(\bar{w}) = \left(\frac{d\bar{z}}{d\bar{w}}\right)^2 \bar{T}(\bar{z}) + \frac{c}{12}\{\bar{z}, \bar{w}\} = \left(\frac{2\pi}{\beta}\right)^2 \left(\bar{z}^2 \bar{T}(\bar{z}) - \frac{1}{48}\right). \quad (70)$$

Due to the conformal symmetry, the action on a cylinder shall be in the exact same form as that on a complex plane:

$$S^C = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int d^2w (\psi^C \bar{\partial} \psi^C + \bar{\psi}^C \partial \bar{\psi}^C), \quad (71)$$

here $\partial = \frac{\partial}{\partial w}$ and $\bar{\partial} = \frac{\partial}{\partial \bar{w}}$ and $d^2w = dt d\sigma$.

2.3.2 Hamiltonian on a Cylinder

Thus, explicitly, the Hamiltonian on a cylinder is given by the standard CFT result as:

Theorem 8. *Hamiltonian on a Cylinder*

The Hamiltonian of a general CFT on a cylinder with circumference β is given by:

$$H = \frac{2\pi}{\beta} \left(L_0 + \bar{L}_0 - \frac{c}{12} \right). \quad (72)$$

Proof: See my BCFT note for details.

Thus for the Majorana CFT, the Hamiltonian on a cylinder is given by:

Theorem 9. *Majorana CFT Hamiltonian on a Cylinder*

The Hamiltonian of the Majorana CFT on a cylinder with circumference β is given by:

$$H = \frac{2\pi}{\beta} \left(L_0 + \bar{L}_0 - \frac{1}{24} \right) \quad (73)$$

$$L_0 = \sum_{k>0} k b_{-k} b_k, \quad \bar{L}_0 = \sum_{k>0} k \bar{b}_{-k} \bar{b}_k, \quad (\text{NS} : k \in \mathbb{Z} + \frac{1}{2}) \quad (74)$$

$$L_0 = \sum_{k>0} k b_{-k} b_k + \frac{1}{16}, \quad \bar{L}_0 = \sum_{k>0} k \bar{b}_{-k} \bar{b}_k + \frac{1}{16}, \quad (\text{R} : k \in \mathbb{Z}) \quad (75)$$

We can prove this by calculating the generator of time translation on a cylinder directly from the energy-momentum tensor, for more details see my BCFT note.

2.3.3 Conformal Transformation to Cylinder (another convention)

Apart from the quite standard convention, we have another commonly used convention:

$$w = \frac{i\beta}{2\pi} \ln z, \bar{w} = -\frac{i\beta}{2\pi} \ln \bar{z} \quad z = e^{\frac{-2\pi i w}{\beta}}, \bar{z} = e^{\frac{2\pi i \bar{w}}{\beta}} \quad (76)$$

$$w = \sigma + it, \quad \bar{w} = \sigma - it \quad (77)$$

Under this map the fermion fields transform as:

$$\psi^C(w) = \left(\frac{dz}{dw}\right)^{1/2} \psi(z) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{i\beta}z\right)^{1/2} \psi(z), \quad (78)$$

$$\bar{\psi}^C(\bar{w}) = \left(\frac{d\bar{z}}{d\bar{w}}\right)^{1/2} \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) = \left(-\frac{2\pi}{i\beta}\bar{z}\right)^{1/2} \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}). \quad (79)$$

Thus the mode expansion on a cylinder is given by:

$$\psi^C(w) = \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{i\beta}} \sum_k b_k e^{-2\pi i k w / \beta} \quad \bar{\psi}^C(\bar{w}) = \sqrt{-\frac{2\pi}{i\beta}} \sum_k \bar{b}_k e^{2\pi k i \bar{w} / \beta} \quad (80)$$

The E-M tensor on a cylinder is given by:

$$T^C(w) = \left(\frac{dz}{dw}\right)^2 T(z) + \frac{c}{12} \{z, w\} = -\left(\frac{2\pi}{\beta}\right)^2 \left(z^2 T(z) - \frac{1}{48}\right), \quad (81)$$

$$\bar{T}^C(\bar{w}) = \left(\frac{d\bar{z}}{d\bar{w}}\right)^2 \bar{T}(\bar{z}) + \frac{c}{12} \{\bar{z}, \bar{w}\} = -\left(\frac{2\pi}{\beta}\right)^2 \left(\bar{z}^2 \bar{T}(\bar{z}) - \frac{1}{48}\right). \quad (82)$$

2.3.4 Hamiltonian on a Cylinder (another convention)

With this convention, the Hamiltonian on a cylinder is given by:

Theorem 10. *Hamiltonian on a Cylinder (another convention)*

The Hamiltonian of a general CFT on a cylinder with circumference β is given by:

$$H^C = \frac{2\pi}{\beta} \left(L_0 - \bar{L}_0 - \frac{c}{12} \right). \quad (83)$$

Proof: Similarly:

$$H^C = \int_0^{-\beta} d\sigma T_{tt}, \quad T_{tt} = -T_{ww} - T_{\bar{w}\bar{w}} = \frac{1}{2\pi} (T^C(w) + \bar{T}^C(\bar{w})). \quad (84)$$

[This is purely my own calculation, I have not find a reference doing this yet, so I have to double check it later.] Note that in this convention, the relation between T_{tt} and the E-M tensor components is different and the intergral contour is different. Thus, we have:

$$H^C = \int_0^{-\beta} d\sigma \frac{1}{2\pi} (T^C(w) + \bar{T}^C(\bar{w})) \quad (85)$$

$$= \frac{2\pi}{\beta} \left(L_0 - \bar{L}_0 - \frac{c}{12} \right). \quad (86)$$

Remark: Note that though we start from a different convention, the final form of the Hamiltonian is exactly the same with the previous one.

3 Majorana BCFT

As a standard way of dealing with boundary CFT, we consider a Majorana CFT on a compactified strip with two boundaries or equivalently a cylinder. We study the boundary state of this theory. For detailed calculation, we refer to [8]. However, I might point out many discussions in these papers are naive and needs further clarification. Thus, I include some clarification here with the insight from [5, 1, 7, 3].

3.1 Boundary Conditions of Majorana CFT

There are two conformally invariant boundary conditions for Majorana CFT. We then discuss how to write them down on a general manifold with boundaries. And then specify the manifold to a compactified strip with two boundaries. The idea is organized in [3]

3.1.1 Boundary Conditions on UHP

It is well known that the Majorana CFT has two conformal boundary conditions on the UHP:

- **Free (+) Boundary Condition:** $\psi = \bar{\psi}$ at the boundary.
- **Fixed (−) Boundary Condition:** $\psi = -\bar{\psi}$ at the boundary.

It is believed that the free boundary condition corresponds to free spin boundary condition of Ising model while the fixed boundary condition corresponds to fixed spin boundary condition of Ising model.

3.1.2 Boundary Conditions on General Manifold

We then want to generalize these conditions to general 2-manifolds with boundaries. Consider a general manifold with boundary $\mathcal{D}$ (not just the UHP) with boundaries $\partial\mathcal{D} = \mathcal{B} = \cup_j \mathcal{B}_j$ that are parametrized as $\mathcal{B}_j = (Z_j(t), \bar{Z}_j(t))$ parametrized by t . On the boundary $\mathcal{B}_j$ the field is $\psi(t) = \psi(Z_j(t)), \bar{\psi}(t) = \bar{\psi}(\bar{Z}_j(t))$. We define the tangent vectors on the boundary as:

$$e_j(t) = \partial_t Z_j(t), \quad \bar{e}_j(t) = \partial_t \bar{Z}_j(t) \quad (87)$$

that satisfy:

- normalization condition: $e(t)\bar{e}(t) = 1$
- orientation condition: $(ie, -i\bar{e})$ vector shall be normal to the boundary and point inward the domain $\mathcal{D}$

Thus, these two conformal boundary conditions on UHP can be generalized to:

- **Free Boundary Condition:** $[e_j^{\frac{1}{2}}\psi - \bar{e}_j^{\frac{1}{2}}\bar{\psi}]_{\mathcal{B}_j} = 0$
- **Fixed Boundary Condition:** $[e_j^{\frac{1}{2}}\psi + \bar{e}_j^{\frac{1}{2}}\bar{\psi}]_{\mathcal{B}_j} = 0$

3.1.3 Boundary Conditions on a Strip

Then we focus on our main topic: Majorana CFT on a compactified strip with two boundaries. We consider the strip $\mathcal{S} = \{z = x + iy | x \in [0, L], y \in \mathbb{R}\}$ with two boundaries at $x = 0$ and $x = L$. Then strip is compactified by identifying $y \sim y + \beta$.

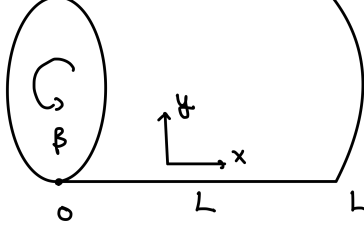


Figure 1: Compatified strip with two boundaries at $x = 0$ and $x = L$, compatified by identifying $y \sim y + \beta$.

On this manifold, we can write down the boundary at $x = 0$ and $x = L$ as:

$$Z_1(t) = -it, \quad \bar{Z}_1(t) = it \quad \text{at } x = 0 \quad (88)$$

$$Z_2(t) = L + it, \quad \bar{Z}_2(t) = L - it \quad \text{at } x = L \quad (89)$$

with this orientation and normalization we have:

$$e_1(t) = -i, \quad \bar{e}_1(t) = i \quad \text{at } x = 0 \quad (90)$$

$$e_2(t) = i, \quad \bar{e}_2(t) = -i \quad \text{at } x = L \quad (91)$$

Thus, the action of Majorana CFT on this compatified strip with two boundaries is:

- **Free (+) Boundary Condition:**

$$\psi(0, y) = i\bar{\psi}(0, y), \quad \psi(L, y) = -i\bar{\psi}(L, y) \quad (92)$$

- **Fixed (−) Boundary Condition:**

$$\psi(0, y) = -i\bar{\psi}(0, y), \quad \psi(L, y) = i\bar{\psi}(L, y) \quad (93)$$

3.2 Open Channel Partition Function

With the boundary conditions in hand we can canonically quantize the Majorana CFT on this compatified strip and get the open channel partition function. Here we will point out some subtleties that are not discussed in some literatures. There ain't a well-defined fermion parity operator in the open channel. Thus, we need to be careful when we do this. We do this with two steps:

- Quantize the theory on a infinite strip with two boundaries, find out the Hilbert Space
This is Extremely Nontrivial
- Compatify the strip and get the partition function

3.2.1 Doubling Trick

We aren't familiar with the mode expansion on a strip and quantization on a strip, however, we have already discussed the theory on a cylinder in section 2.3. Thus we may use a trick to double a strip and get a cylinder. This is the so-called doubling trick.

We can write the two boundary conditions in a compact form:

$$\psi(0, y) + ai\bar{\psi}(0, y) = 0 \quad \psi(L, y) - bi\bar{\psi}(L, y) = 0, \quad (94)$$

- when $a = b = 1$ we have the fixed (−) boundary condition at both boundaries
- when $a = b = -1$ we have the free (+) boundary condition at both boundaries

- when $a = -b = 1$ we have the mixed boundary condition: fixed at $x = 0$ and free at $x = L$
- when $a = -b = -1$ we have the mixed boundary condition: free at $x = 0$ and fixed at $x = L$

then we define an auxiliary field $\bar{\psi}_0(x, y) = -a\bar{\psi}(x, y)$. Thus the boundary condition can be written as:

$$\psi(0, y) = i\bar{\psi}_0(0, y) \quad \psi(L, y) = -i\frac{b}{a}\bar{\psi}_0(L, y) \quad (95)$$

Then we can extend the field $\psi(x, y)$ to the region $x \in [-L, L]$ by defining:

Definition 11. Doubled Theory

We define a field on the strip $[-L, L] \times \mathbb{R}$ with:

$$\Psi(x, y) = \begin{cases} \psi(x, y) & \text{if } x \in [0, L] \\ i\bar{\psi}_0(-x, y) & \text{if } x \in [-L, 0] \end{cases} \quad (96)$$

The original action can be written as:

$$S^S = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^L dx \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy [\psi \bar{\partial} \psi + \bar{\psi} \partial \bar{\psi}] = S^C = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-L}^L dx \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} dy \Psi \bar{\partial} \Psi = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_z \Psi \bar{\partial} \Psi \quad (97)$$

where $z = x + iy$.

We can see that at the $x = 0$ boundary, the field $\Psi(x, y)$ is continuous. While at the $x = L$ boundary, we have:

$$\Psi(L, y) = -\frac{b}{a}\Psi(-L, y) \quad (98)$$

Thus we can understand the theory of two decoupled fields $\psi(x, y)$ and $\bar{\psi}(x, y)$ on a strip with boundary conditions as a theory of a single field $\Psi(x, y)$ on a circle of circumference $2L$.

- same boundary conditions ($a = b$) correspond to the Neveu-Schwarz (NS) sector with anti-periodic boundary condition: $\Psi(L, y) = -\Psi(-L, y)$
- different boundary conditions ($a = -b$) correspond to the Ramond (R) sector with periodic boundary condition: $\Psi(L, y) = \Psi(-L, y)$

Eventually, we learn that the Majorana CFT on a strip is equivalent to a Chiral Majorana CFT on a cylinder with NS and R boundary conditions. We then can perform the quantization on a cylinder to get the quantized theory.

3.2.2 Canonical Quantization

A canonical method of quantizing on a cylinder is transform it onto a complex plane, do the radial quantization and then transform it back to the cylinder. We have already discussed this procedure in section 2.3. Here we just list the results:

- **Mode Expansion:** the mode expansion of the field $\Psi(z)$ on the cylinder is:

$$\Psi(z) = \sqrt{\frac{\pi}{iL}} \sum_k b_k e^{-\frac{\pi}{L}ikz}, \quad z = x + iy \quad (99)$$

Where the commutation relation of the modes is:

$$\{b_k, b_{k'}\} = \delta_{k+k',0} \quad (100)$$

For the NS sector (Same BC), $k \in \mathbb{Z} + \frac{1}{2}$ while for the R sector (Different BC), $k \in \mathbb{Z}$.

Remark: In fact there is a little convention problem here for x is defined on $[-L, L]$ we need an extra global phase factor. Yet it is a symmetry of the theory thus we ignore it here.

- **Hamiltonian:** The Hamiltonian of the theory is:

$$H_{open} = \frac{\pi}{L} \left(\sum_{k>0} k b_{-k} b_k + E_0 \right) \quad (101)$$

where the zero-point energy E_0 is:

$$E_0 = \begin{cases} -\frac{1}{48} & \text{NS sector} \\ \frac{1}{24} & \text{R sector} \end{cases} \quad (102)$$

Proof: This is just the Hamiltonian on a cylinder with circumference $\beta = 2L$ and central charge $c = \frac{1}{2}$ see section 2.3. Yet only one chiral part.

Remark: In fact, I have tried, in this standard convention, the Hamiltonian comes directly from legendre transformation of the chiral Lagrangian.

3.2.3 Zero Mode and Ground State Degeneracy(?)

With a chiral Majorana fermion on a cylinder, when considering the Ramond sector, we know that the zero mode only has one-dimensional Clifford algebra:

$$\{b_0, b_0\} = 1 \quad b_0^2 = \frac{1}{2} \quad (103)$$

Naively, we may think that we only have one ground state $|0\rangle_R$ satisfying $b_k|0\rangle = 0$ for $k > 0$. The zero mode b_0 then acts on the ground state as:

$$b_0 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} |0\rangle_R \quad \text{or} \quad b_0 = -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} |0\rangle_R \quad (104)$$

However, things get worse when we try to define the fermion parity operator $(-1)^F$. This is due to a mathematical theorem:

Theorem 11. Odd Dimensional Clifford Algebra Grading

Clifford algebra with odd number of generators doesn't admit a $\mathbb{Z}_2$ grading, ie there is no way to define a fermion parity operator $(-1)^F$ that anti-commutes with all the generators.

3.2.4 Boundary Fermion

However, we **manually wish to define** a fermion parity operator $(-1)^F$ and **we wish to** have a ground state degeneracy. The motivations are:

- We wish to discuss Bosonization which needs a well-defined fermion parity operator to proceed.
- We wish to have 4 different partition functions just as the cylinder case.

Thus, we play the following trick:

Theorem 12. *Boundary Fermion Trick*

We introduce an auxiliary boundary free Majorana fermion $\xi(t)$ with dynamical terms only on the boundary of one of the boundary conditions. we have two choices:

- Add $\xi(t)$ on the free boundary condition boundary
- Add $\xi(t)$ on the fixed boundary condition boundary

The action of the boundary fermion is:

$$S_\xi = \frac{i}{4} \int dt \xi(t) \frac{d}{dt} \xi(t) \quad (105)$$

Under canonical quantization, the boundary fermion satisfies the anti-commutation relation:

$$\{\xi(t), \xi(t')\} = 2\delta(t - t') \quad (106)$$

This defines a extra boundary Hilbert space $\mathcal{H}_B = \text{Span}\{|0\rangle_B, \xi|0\rangle_B\}$.

With this boundary fermion, we can define the fermion parity operator and have a ground state degeneracy.

- **Case 1: Single Boundary Fermion** when we have different boundary conditions at the two boundaries, there exists a single boundary fermion $\xi(t)$ on the free boundary only.

The boundary fermion serves as a quantum mechanical fermion degree of freedom on the boundary. Apparently, it has nothing to do with the bulk Majorana fermion $\Psi(z)$. However, it provides an extra zero mode ξ that satisfies:

$$\{\xi, \xi\} = 2 \quad \xi^2 = 2, \quad \{\xi, b_k\} = 0 \quad \forall k \quad (107)$$

We certainly have a ground state degeneracy, to represent the Clifford algebra generated by b_0 and ξ :

$$\{b_0, \xi\} = 0, \quad b_0^2 = \frac{1}{2}, \quad \xi^2 = 2 \quad (108)$$

Thus, we play exactly the same trick as in section 2.2.5 to define the degenerate ground states. And the Hilbert space is given by acting the bulk negative modes b_{-k} ($k = 1, 2, 3, \dots$) on the degenerate ground states.

- **Case 2: Double Boundary Fermions** when we have same boundary conditions at the two boundaries, there might exist two boundary fermions $\xi_1(t)$ and $\xi_2(t)$ on both boundaries.

In this case, the bulk Majorana fermion has no zero mode thus there is no ground state degeneracy from the bulk. However, the two boundary fermions ξ_1 and ξ_2 generate a two-dimensional Clifford algebra:

$$\{\xi_i, \xi_j\} = 2\delta_{ij}, \quad \xi_i^2 = 2, \quad \{\xi_i, b_k\} = 0 \quad \forall k \quad (109)$$

[I came up with this idea recently, I haven't find any reference discussing this case yet. I think it is true] We then can play the same trick as in section 2.2.4 to define the degenerate ground states. And the Hilbert space is given by acting the bulk negative modes b_{-k} ($k = 1/2, 3/2, \dots$) on the degenerate ground states.

3.2.5 Fermion Parity Operator

- **Same boundary conditions with no boundary fermions**

For this case, there is no zero mode thus we can define the fermion parity operator as usual:

$$(-1)^F = (-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}} = (-1)^{\sum_{k>0} b_{-k} b_k} \quad (110)$$

- **Different boundary conditions with one boundary fermions**

In this case, we have two zero modes b_0 and ξ that generate a two-dimensional Clifford algebra. We play the exact same trick to define the degenerate ground states as we do in section 2.2.4. We define the fermion parity operator as:

$$(-1)^F = \begin{cases} -\sqrt{2}i\xi b_0(-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}}. \\ \sqrt{2}i\xi b_0(-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}}. \end{cases} \quad (111)$$

We have two choices here, yet they matter no difference in the final partition function. We may just pick any one of them. We commonly use $(-1)^F = \sqrt{2}i\xi b_0(-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}}$.

- **Same boundary conditions with two boundary fermions**

In this case, we have two boundary fermions ξ_1 and ξ_2 that generate a two-dimensional Clifford algebra. We play the exact same trick to define the degenerate ground states as we do in section 2.2.4. We define the fermion parity operator as:

$$(-1)^F = \begin{cases} -i\xi_1\xi_2(-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}}. \\ i\xi_1\xi_2(-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}}. \end{cases} \quad (112)$$

We have two choices here, yet they matter no difference in the final partition function. We may just pick any one of them. We commonly use $(-1)^F = i\xi_1\xi_2(-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}}$.

3.2.6 0A Theory and 0B Theory

We have claimed that there are two ways of adding the boundary fermion: on the free boundary or on the fixed boundary. We name these two theories as:

- **0A Theory:** adding the boundary fermion on the free (+) boundary condition boundary.
- **0B Theory:** adding the boundary fermion on the fixed (−) boundary condition boundary.

As we will see eventually, these two theories correspond to the choice of type 0A fermion parity and type 0B fermion parity in the closed channel. **From now on, we will focus on the 0A theory only. The 0B theory can be treated similarly.**

3.2.7 Open Channel Hilbert Space

With all the ingredients in hand, we can finally calculate the open channel partition function of Majorana CFT on a compatified strip with two boundaries. We first list out all sort of boundary conditions we can have and give them a name, we call **free boundary condition** as + and **fixed boundary condition** as −. Thus we have 4 different types of boundary conditions:

- (+, +) boundary conditions: both boundaries have free boundary conditions. There are two boundary fermions, one on each boundary for the 0A theory.
- (−, −) boundary conditions: both boundaries have fixed boundary conditions. There is no boundary fermion for the 0A theory.

- $(+, -)$ boundary conditions: the boundary at $x = 0$ is free and the boundary at $x = L$ is fixed. There is a boundary fermion only on the free boundary.
- $(-, +)$ boundary conditions: the boundary at $x = 0$ is fixed and the boundary at $x = L$ is free. There is a boundary fermion only on the free boundary.

The Hilbert spaces corresponding to the four types of boundary conditions are:

- $(+, +)$ boundary conditions: the chiral NS sector Hilbert space tensored with two boundary-fermion Hilbert spaces,

$$\mathcal{H}_{(++)} = \mathcal{H}_{\text{NS}}^C \otimes \mathcal{H}_B^{(1)} \otimes \mathcal{H}_B^{(2)}.$$

It is generated by acting negative modes b_{-k} ($k \in \mathbb{Z} + \frac{1}{2} > 0$) on the degenerate ground states. The Hilbert space has twice the size of the $(-, -)$ case.

- $(-, -)$ boundary conditions: the chiral bulk NS sector Hilbert space,

$$\mathcal{H}_{(--) } = \mathcal{H}_{\text{NS}}^C,$$

generated by acting negative modes b_{-k} ($k \in \mathbb{Z} + \frac{1}{2}$) on the NS ground state $|0\rangle_{\text{NS}}$.

- $(+, -)$ boundary conditions: the bulk R sector Hilbert space tensored with a single boundary-fermion Hilbert space,

$$\mathcal{H}_{(+-)} = \mathcal{H}_{\text{R}}^C \otimes \mathcal{H}_B.$$

It is generated by acting negative modes b_{-k} ($k \in \mathbb{Z} > 0$) on the degenerate R ground states. This Hilbert space is twice as large as the $(+, +)$ case.

- $(-, +)$ boundary conditions: identical in structure to the $(+, -)$ case,

$$\mathcal{H}_{(-+)} = \mathcal{H}_{\text{R}}^C \otimes \mathcal{H}_B.$$

3.2.8 Open Channel Partition Functions

Then we can finally calculate the partition functions in the open channel. The partition function is defined as:

Definition 12. Open Channel Partition Function

The open channel partition function is defined as:

$$Z = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}} \left[e^{-\beta H} \right] \quad (113)$$

Yet for fermions we can compatify with periodic or anti-periodic boundary condition, thus we have 2 different partition functions:

$$Z_- = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}} \left[(-1)^F e^{-\beta H} \right] \quad Z_+ = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}} \left[e^{-\beta H} \right] \quad (114)$$

We commonly use $q = e^{-\pi\beta/L}$ for simpler notation.

The two kinds of partition functions are equivalent to compatifying the time direction with anti-periodic and periodic boundary conditions respectively. This can be shown easily using the operter formalism:

$$\text{Tr}[\psi(\tau + \beta)e^{-\beta H}] = \text{Tr}[e^{\beta H}\psi(\tau)e^{-\beta H}e^{-\beta H}] = \text{Tr}[\psi(\tau)e^{-\beta H}]. \quad (115)$$

If we then plug in the fermion parity operator $(-1)^F$, we have:

$$\text{Tr}[\psi(\tau + \beta)(-1)^F e^{-\beta H}] = -\text{Tr}[\psi(\tau)(-1)^F e^{-\beta H}]. \quad (116)$$

The -1 is taken when anti-commuting ψ passes through $(-1)^F$. Thus, we see that the partition function with $(-1)^F$ inserted corresponds to anti-periodic boundary condition in time direction while the one without $(-1)^F$ corresponds to periodic boundary condition in time direction.

We then calculate the partition functions for the 4 types of boundary conditions, we review that the Hamiltonian is given by eq. (101). Thus, we have the following results, and they can be explicitly written in terms of Ising model characters as well:

- $(-, -)$ boundary conditions partition functions:

$$Z_{(--),-} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{(-)}} \left[(-1)^F e^{-\beta H} \right] = q^{-\frac{1}{48}} \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 - q^{n+\frac{1}{2}} \right) = \chi_0(q) - \chi_{1/2}(q), \quad (117)$$

$$Z_{(--),+} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{(-)}} \left[e^{-\frac{\pi\beta}{L}(L_0 - \frac{c}{24})} \right] = q^{-\frac{1}{48}} \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 + q^{n+\frac{1}{2}} \right) = \chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q). \quad (118)$$

- $(+, +)$ boundary conditions partition functions:

$$Z_{(++),-} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{(+)}} \left[(-1)^F e^{-\beta H} \right] = 0 \quad (119)$$

$$Z_{(++),+} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{(+)}} \left[e^{-\frac{\pi\beta}{L}(L_0 - \frac{c}{24})} \right] = 2q^{-\frac{1}{48}} \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 + q^{n+\frac{1}{2}} \right) = 2(\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)) \quad (120)$$

Again, the degenerate ground states cancel each other in $Z_{(++),-}$.

- $(-, +)$ and $(+, -)$ boundary conditions partition functions:

$$Z_{(-+),-} = Z_{(+-),+} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{(-+)}} \left[(-1)^F e^{-\beta H} \right] = 0 \quad (121)$$

$$Z_{(-+),+} = Z_{(+-),-} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{(-+)}} \left[e^{-\frac{\pi\beta}{L}(L_0 - \frac{c}{24})} \right] = 2q^{\frac{1}{24}} \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} (1 + q^n) = 2\chi_{1/16}(q) \quad (122)$$

As before, the degenerate ground states cancel in $Z_{(-+),-}$.

Under the modular transformation $\tilde{q} = e^{-4\pi L/\beta}$, the partition functions become:

Partition Function	q character	$\tilde{q}$ character
$Z_{(--),-}$	$\chi_0(q) - \chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\sqrt{2}\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$
$Z_{(--),+}$	$\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})$
$Z_{(++),-}$	0	0
$Z_{(++),+}$	$2(\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q))$	$2(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$
$Z_{(-+),-}$	0	0
$Z_{(-+),+}$	$2\chi_{1/16}(q)$	$\sqrt{2}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$

Table 2: Free fermion open-channel partition functions in both q and $\tilde{q}$ characters.

3.3 Closed Channel Partition Function

After the calculation of the open channel partition function, we want to identify the boundary states that corresponds to the two boundary conditions (in fact 4 boundary states due to that we consider 2 ways of compatifying the strip). Yet the discussion on BCFT are mostly on a Bosonic state, we need to define a proper boundary state formalism for Fermions.

3.3.1 Fermionic Boundary State Formalism

We try to generalize the definition of boundary state in Bosonic CFT to Fermionic CFT. An obvious observation tells us different ways of compatifying the strip correspond to different boundary states. Thus it is natural to define:

Definition 13. *Fermionic Boundary State*

We define the boundary state $|\alpha, NS\rangle$ and $|\alpha, R\rangle$ in Fermionic CFT as the state that satisfies: test

$$\langle \alpha, NS | e^{-L_1 H_{\text{closed}}} | \beta, NS \rangle = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{\alpha\beta}} (e^{-L_2 H_{\text{open}}}) = Z_{(\alpha\beta),+}, \quad (123)$$

$$\langle \alpha, R | e^{-L_1 H_{\text{closed}}} | \beta, R \rangle = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}_{\alpha\beta}} ((-1)^F e^{-L_2 H_{\text{open}}}) = Z_{(\alpha\beta),-}. \quad (124)$$

Thus for every boundary condition α, β , we have two boundary states $|\alpha, NS\rangle$ and $|\alpha, R\rangle$. Here, we will manage to find the boudnary states that correspond to the 4 types of boundary conditions we have discussed in the open channel.

3.3.2 Canonical Quantization in Closed Channel

The closed channel is merely the Majorana CFT on a cylinder with circumference β and length L . We have already discussed the canonical quantization of Majorana CFT on a cylinder in section 2.3. To be more convenient, we just use the standard transformation from the complex plane to the cylinder, and here's the results:

- **Mode Expansion:** the mode expansion of field $\psi(z)$ and $\bar{\psi}(\bar{z})$ is given by:

$$\psi^C(z) = \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{\beta}} \sum_k a_k e^{-2\pi k z / \beta} \quad \bar{\psi}^C(\bar{z}) = \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{\beta}} \sum_k \bar{a}_k e^{-2\pi k \bar{z} / \beta} \quad (125)$$

where now $z = x - iy$, now x direction is the time direction. The commutation relation of the modes is:

$$\{a_k, a_{k'}\} = \delta_{k+k',0}, \quad \{\bar{a}_k, \bar{a}_{k'}\} = \delta_{k+k',0} \quad (126)$$

- **Hamiltonian:** The Hamiltonian of the theory is:

$$H_{\text{closed}} = \frac{2\pi}{\beta} \left(2E_0 + \sum_{k>0} k (a_{-k} a_k + \bar{a}_{-k} \bar{a}_k) \right) \quad (127)$$

Similarly:

$$E_0 = \begin{cases} -\frac{1}{48} & \text{NS sector} \\ \frac{1}{24} & \text{R sector} \end{cases} \quad (128)$$

- **Fermion Parity:** for a free fermion on a cylinder we know that fermion parity operators are as follows:

$$(-1)^F = \begin{cases} (-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}} & \text{NS sector} \\ \pm 2ia_0\bar{a}_0(-1)^{F_{\text{nz}}} & \text{R sector} \end{cases} \quad (129)$$

Here $F_{\text{nz}} = \sum_{k>0} a_{-k}a_k + \sum_{k>0} \bar{a}_{-k}\bar{a}_k$ is the non-zero mode fermion number operator. The $\pm$ in the R sector corresponds to the two different choices of fermion parity operator. We then will see that when considering a 0A theory, we have to use the $-2ia_0\bar{a}_0$ choice or so called type 0A fermion parity.

Remark: for the modes in the closed channel, we use $a_k, \bar{a}_k$ to show that it has nothing to do with the modes in the open channel b_k .

3.3.3 Gluing Conditions and Ishibashi States

Imposing the boundary conditions shall turn into gluing condition for the parent CFT. We now clarify the procedure and give out the results. First of all, the parent CFT is defined on a cylinder with coordinate $z = x + iy$. It is quantized by radial quantization on a plane with coordinate ξ . Till now this have nothing to do with a BCFT just a standard CFT on a cylinder.

However, we have to relate it to a BCFT with boundary and project the boundary toward a circle on ξ plane and which will lead to imposing the gluing condition. Thus we take the following standard procedure, we consider a Majorana CFT on a UHP with coordinate $w = x + iy$, where $z = \bar{z}$ is the boundary. Then we have two types of boundary conditions:

- **Free (+) Boundary Condition:** this boundary condition requires:

$$\psi(z) = \bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) \quad \text{at } z = \bar{z}. \quad (130)$$

- **Fixed (−) Boundary Condition:** this boundary condition requires:

$$\psi(z) = -\bar{\psi}(\bar{z}) \quad \text{at } z = \bar{z}. \quad (131)$$

- **Inner Circle Condition**

Then we make a conformal transformation to transform the $z = \bar{z} \in \mathbb{R}_+$ part to the inner circle of the ξ plane. A commonly used conformal transformation is:

$$\xi = e^{\frac{2\pi i}{\beta} \ln z} \quad \bar{\xi} = e^{-\frac{2\pi i}{\beta} \ln \bar{z}}. \quad (132)$$

Under this transformation, the majorana fermion transforms as:

$$\psi^P(\xi) = \left(\frac{2\pi}{\beta} \frac{\xi}{w} \right)^{1/2} \psi^H(w), \quad \bar{\psi}^P(\bar{\xi}) = \left(-\frac{2\pi}{\beta} \frac{\bar{\xi}}{\bar{w}} \right)^{1/2} \bar{\psi}^H(\bar{w}). \quad (133)$$

Remark: we use C to denote the field on the cylinder and P to denote the field on the plane. and we use H to denote the field on the UHP.

Thus for the inner circle $|\xi| = 1$, we have:

- **Free (+) Boundary Condition:**

$$\psi^P(\xi) = i\bar{\psi}^P(\bar{\xi}) \quad \text{at } |\xi| = 1. \quad (134)$$

- **Fixed (−) Boundary Condition:**

$$\psi^P(\xi) = -i\bar{\psi}^P(\bar{\xi}) \quad \text{at } |\xi| = 1. \quad (135)$$

Then we mode expand the fields on the plane and plug in the mode expansion to get the gluing conditions on the modes. We finally have:

- **Free (+) Boundary Condition:**

$$(a_k - i\bar{a}_{-k})|+, NS/R\rangle = 0, \quad \langle +, NS/R|(a_{-k} + i\bar{a}_k) = 0, \quad (136)$$

- **Fixed (-) Boundary Condition:**

$$(a_k + i\bar{a}_{-k})|-, NS/R\rangle = 0, \quad \langle -, NS/R|(a_{-k} - i\bar{a}_k) = 0, \quad (137)$$

For these gluing condition, it is able to construct a set of Ishibashi states that satisfy them:

- **NS Sector Ishibashi States:**

$$|\pm, NS\rangle\rangle = \prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} e^{i\pm a_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}}|0\rangle_{\text{NS}} \quad (138)$$

The + state is solution to the gluing condition of free boundary condition while the - state is solution to the gluing condition of fixed boundary condition.

- **R Sector Ishibashi States:**

$$|\pm, R\rangle\rangle = \prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+} e^{i\pm a_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}}|\pm\rangle_R \quad (139)$$

The + state is solution to the gluing condition of free boundary condition while the - state is solution to the gluing condition of fixed boundary condition. And $|\pm\rangle_R$ are the degenerate R ground states which we have discussed in section 2.2.4. solutions to different gluing conditions corresponds to different choices of R ground states, this is because the gluing conditions on zero modes are:

$$(a_0 - i\bar{a}_0)|+, R\rangle = 0, \quad (140)$$

$$(a_0 + i\bar{a}_0)|-, R\rangle = 0. \quad (141)$$

It can be seen by plugging in the definition eq. (58).

Proof:

I'll sketch the proof for NS sector and the free (+) boundary condition here. R sector only differs from the discussion of the zero modes. We shall verify that the Ishibashi state indeed satisfies the gluing condition. Due to the anti-commutation relation of the modes, we have:

$$e^{ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}} = 1 + ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}. \quad (142)$$

This in total behaves as a bosonic operator so we can change the order of acting them on the vacuum state freely. Then we consider the action of $(a_k - i\bar{a}_{-k})$ on the Ishibashi state, we assume $k > 0$ the other case is rather similar. We have:

$$(a_k - i\bar{a}_{-k})(1 + ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}) = a_k + ia_k a_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k} - i\bar{a}_{-k} - \bar{a}_{-k}a_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k} \quad (143)$$

$$= a_k - i\bar{a}_{-k} + ia_k a_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k} \quad (144)$$

$$= a_k - i\bar{a}_{-k}(a_{-k}a_k) \quad (145)$$

$$(146)$$

Acting on vacuum this will give zero. $\square$

3.3.4 Boundary States and Partition Functions

We now that boundary states shall be linear combinations of the Ishibashi states we have constructed. However, we notice that for every boundary condition only exists one corresponding Ishibashi state. **Thus, the boundary states are merely the Ishibashi states themselves up to a normalization factor**

$$|+, NS\rangle \propto |\pm, NS\rangle, \quad |-, NS\rangle \propto |-, NS\rangle, \quad (147)$$

$$|+, R\rangle \propto |+, R\rangle, \quad |-, R\rangle \propto |-, R\rangle. \quad (148)$$

We now have to find out the normalization factor using the definition of fermionic boundary state (which sometimes are called spin Cardy's condition). To do this we first calculate the partition function of Ishibashi states, this can be done explicitly:

$$\langle\langle \pm, NS | e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} | \pm, NS \rangle\rangle = \tilde{q}^{-\frac{1}{48}} \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 + \tilde{q}^{n+\frac{1}{2}}\right) = \chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}), \quad (149)$$

$$\langle\langle \mp, NS | e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} | \pm, NS \rangle\rangle = \tilde{q}^{-\frac{1}{48}} \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 - \tilde{q}^{n+\frac{1}{2}}\right) = \chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}), \quad (150)$$

$$\langle\langle \pm, R | e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} | \pm, R \rangle\rangle = \tilde{q}^{\frac{1}{24}} \prod_{n=1}^{\infty} (1 + \tilde{q}^n) = \chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q}), \quad (151)$$

$$\langle\langle \mp, R | e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} | \pm, R \rangle\rangle = 0. \quad (152)$$

Proof: This is done by plugging in the definition and do straightforward calculation. For example, for the first one we can first calculate the commutation relation between the Hamiltonian and operators:

$$[H_{\text{closed}}, a_{-k}] = \frac{2\pi}{\beta} k a_{-k}, \quad [H_{\text{closed}}, \bar{a}_{-k}] = \frac{2\pi}{\beta} k \bar{a}_{-k} \quad (153)$$

From this we can have:

$$e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k} e^{LH_{\text{closed}}} = e^{-\frac{4\pi L}{\beta} k} a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k} \quad (154)$$

Then we use the fact that:

$$(1 - i\bar{a}_k a_k)(1 + i\omega_k a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k}) = 1 + i\omega_k a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k} - i\bar{a}_k a_k + \omega_k \bar{a}_k a_k a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k} \quad \text{where} \quad \omega_k = e^{-\frac{4\pi L}{\beta} k} \quad (155)$$

When act on vacuum the only non-zero contribution comes from the first and the last term. Thus we have:

$$1 + \omega_k \bar{a}_k a_k a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k} \sim 1 + \omega_k \quad (156)$$

contribution from each term. In total we have:

$$\langle\langle +, NS | e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} | +, NS \rangle\rangle = \tilde{q}^{-\frac{1}{48}} \prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} \left(1 + e^{-\frac{4\pi L}{\beta} k}\right) \quad (157)$$

$$= \tilde{q}^{-\frac{1}{48}} \prod_{n=0}^{\infty} \left(1 + \tilde{q}^{n+\frac{1}{2}}\right) \quad (158)$$

The first term comes from the vacuum energy. The other cases are rather similar. $\square$

where we have used the modular transformation of Ising characters and $\tilde{q} = e^{-4\pi L/\beta}$. we compare these results with the open channel partition functions in table 2 and find out the normalization factors. We have:

$$|-, NS\rangle = |-, NS\rangle\rangle \quad (159)$$

$$|-, R\rangle = \sqrt[4]{2}|-, R\rangle\rangle, \quad (160)$$

$$|+, NS\rangle = \sqrt{2}|+, NS\rangle\rangle, \quad (161)$$

$$|+, R\rangle = 0|+, R\rangle\rangle = 0. \quad (162)$$

We calculate the partition functions and list them out in a table:

Open Channel	q character	$\tilde{q}$ character	Closed Channel
$Z_{(--),-}$	$\chi_0(q) - \chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\sqrt{2}\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle -, R e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} -, R \rangle$
$Z_{(--),+}$	$\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle -, NS e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} -, NS \rangle$
$Z_{(++),-}$	0	0	$\langle +, R e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} +, R \rangle$
$Z_{(++),+}$	$2(\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q))$	$2(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$	$\langle +, NS e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} +, NS \rangle$
$Z_{(-+),-}$	0	0	$\langle -, R e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} +, R \rangle$
$Z_{(-+),+}$	$2\chi_{1/16}(q)$	$\sqrt{2}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$	$\langle -, NS e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} +, NS \rangle$

Table 3: Free fermion open-channel partition functions in both q and $\tilde{q}$ characters, with the corresponding closed-channel overlaps.

This table summarize the main results of this section. We have successfully identified the boundary states that correspond to the two boundary conditions in Majorana CFT with boundary fermions.

4 Bosonization of Majorana BCFT

Now we finally get to the main topic of this note, Bosonization. We will discuss how to bosonize the Majorana CFT with boundaries in closed channel. This topic has been discussed in several references, [7, 5]. Yet non of them gives a complete and clear explanation of the process. The following will be my understanding of the bosonization of Majorana BCFT.

4.1 GSO Projection and $\mathbb{Z}_2$ Orbifold

Bosonization is transforming a fermionic theory into a bosonic theory. A naive idea of changing a fermionic theory into a bosonic theory is to simply bind all fermions in pairs. When two fermions are paired, they can behave as a boson.

4.1.1 GSO Projection

This naive idea works well, and mathematically bosonization of a partition function and Hilbert space can be described as the GSO projection in fermionic theory or the $\mathbb{Z}_2$ orbifold. First let's define GSO projection.

Definition 14. *GSO Projection*

Nsively, it can be understood as projecting into Hilbert Space with even fermion number. Mathematically, if we have a fermionic theory with a well defined $\mathbb{Z}_2$ grading of fermion parity operator $(-1)^F$, we can define the GSO projected partition function as:

$$Z_{GSO} = \text{Tr}_{\mathcal{H}} \left[\frac{1 + (-1)^F}{2} e^{-\beta H} \right] \quad (163)$$

We can see that we impose a projection operator $P_{GSO} = \frac{1 + (-1)^F}{2}$ on states satisfy:

$$|odd\rangle_{GSO} = \frac{1 + (-1)^F}{2} |odd\rangle = 0, \quad |even\rangle_{GSO} = \frac{1 + (-1)^F}{2} |even\rangle = |even\rangle \quad (164)$$

By definition.

4.1.2 Bosonization with boundaries

When it comes to a boudnary theory, we not only have to consider the GSO projection of the Hilbert space, but also the boundary conditions (in open channel) or the boundary states (in closed channel). For a abstract boundary condition, it might be hard to understand how to "project" it. However, for a boundary state, we certainly can just act the projector on it and use the projected boundary state to construct the bosonized theory.

4.2 Closed channel Bosonization

The closed channel is rather easy to understand (and I only understand this). I propose that the bosonization of boundary states shall satisfy the two consistent steps:

- Boundary States are GSO projected, we only keep the boundary states with even fermion parity.
- Choose the Linear combination of GSO projected boundary states that satisfies the Cardy's condition and are elementary boundary states. To make it a valid bosonic boundary state.

With these two conditions in have, we can uniquely determine the bosonized boundary states and see they are **exactly** the known boundary states in Ising CFT.

4.2.1 Fermionic Parity and 0A/0B Theories

In the closed channel, in order to impose the GSO projection, we first need to define the fermionic parity operator $(-1)^F$. As we have discussed alot, we have two ways of defining the fermionic parity operator in R sector Majorana CFT, the type 0A and type 0B ones:

$$(-1)^F = \begin{cases} -2i b_0 \bar{b}_0 (-1)^{F_{nz}}, & \text{type 0A} \\ +2i b_0 \bar{b}_0 (-1)^{F_{nz}}. & \text{type 0B} \end{cases} \quad (165)$$

Here, with the above discussion of 0A theory, **we can see that we must use type 0A fermionic parity** or the theory may be trivial in R sector.

4.2.2 GSO Projection of Boundary States

We demand the first consistent condition:

- **Boundary States** are GSO projected, we only keep the boundary states with even fermion parity.

For the NS sector we may find the GSO projection is trivial, for we construct the Ishibashi states as:

$$|\pm, NS\rangle\rangle = \prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} e^{i\pm a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k}} |0\rangle_{\text{NS}} \quad (166)$$

Both of them have even fermion parity for we generate it from the vacuum with $a_{-k} \bar{a}_{-k}$ bounded together. Thus we have for the boundary states in NS sector:

$$|\pm, NS\rangle_{\text{GSO}} = |\pm, NS\rangle \quad (167)$$

For the R sector in a 0A theory, we only have one non-zero boundary state $|- , R\rangle$. If we define the fermion parity operator as type 0A one, we can easily check that:

$$(-1)^F |- , R\rangle = + |- , R\rangle \Rightarrow |- , R\rangle_{\text{GSO}} = |- , R\rangle \quad (168)$$

Witch seems to work well. However, if we define the fermion parity operator as type 0B one, we will get:

$$(-1)^F |- , R\rangle = - |- , R\rangle \Rightarrow |- , R\rangle_{\text{GSO}} = 0 \quad (169)$$

which means the R sector is completely projected out. Thus we must use type 0A fermionic parity operator to have a non-trivial R sector. **That's also the reason why we call putting a fermion on (+) boundary a type 0A theory.** for we must use type 0A fermionic parity operator to have a non-trivial R sector.

4.2.3 Final Bosonized Boundary States

Thus after a GSO projection, we have three non-trivial boundary states:

- **fixed boundary states:** we have two projected boundary states $|- , NS\rangle$ and $|- , R\rangle$.
- **free boundary state:** we have one projected boundary state $|+ , NS\rangle$.

Then we **propose** that the final bosonized boundary states shall be in the linear combination of these projected boundary states that:

- Satisfy the Cardy's condition.

- Are elementary boundary states.

To do this, we shall first list out the overlaps of these boundary states:

q character	$\tilde{q}$ character	Closed Channel
$\chi_0(q) - \chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\sqrt{2} \chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle -, R e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} -, R \rangle$
$\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle -, NS e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} -, NS \rangle$
$2(\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q))$	$2(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$	$\langle +, NS e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} +, NS \rangle$
$2\chi_{1/16}(q)$	$\sqrt{2}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$	$\langle -, NS e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} +, NS \rangle$

Table 4: Free fermion partition functions keeping only even parity.

If we only consider one sector, we can't construct such a solution. However, if we do a trick and "combine the R sector and the NS sector together" (this is quite subtle, I will later on explain my understandings), we can find the solution:

$$|f\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} |+, NS\rangle \quad (170)$$

$$|+\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|-, NS\rangle + |-, R\rangle) \quad (171)$$

$$|-\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|-, NS\rangle - |-, R\rangle) \quad (172)$$

In fact we can never "sum" a ramond sector state with a NS sector state. What we do is in fact **Direct Sum** the two Hilbert spaces, thus it should be written as:

$$|f\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} |+, NS\rangle \oplus 0 \quad (173)$$

$$|+\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|-, NS\rangle \oplus |-, R\rangle) \quad (174)$$

$$|-\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|-, NS\rangle \oplus -|-, R\rangle) \quad (175)$$

And the evolution operator in the partition function should also be written as:

$$e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} = e^{-LH_{\text{closedNS}}} \oplus e^{-LH_{\text{closedR}}} \quad (176)$$

With these in hand we calculate the partition function of these direct summed state in the direct summed Hilbert space:

q character	$\tilde{q}$ character	Closed Channel
$\chi_0(q)$	$\frac{1}{2}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle + e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} + \rangle$
$\chi_0(q)$	$\frac{1}{2}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle - e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} - \rangle$
$\chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\frac{1}{2}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\chi_{1/16}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle - e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} + \rangle$
$\chi_0(q) + \chi_{1/2}(q)$	$\chi_0(\tilde{q}) + \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q})$	$\langle f e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} f \rangle$
$\chi_{1/16}(q)$	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$	$\langle + e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} f \rangle$
$\chi_{1/16}(q)$	$\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\chi_0(\tilde{q}) - \chi_{1/2}(\tilde{q}))$	$\langle - e^{-LH_{\text{closed}}} f \rangle$

Table 5: Partition function of the bosonized boundary states.

We compare the above table with the known Ising CFT boundary states partition functions table 1 and we find they are exactly the same! Thus we identify the bosonized theory as the Ising CFT with boundary states:

$$|f\rangle = |f\rangle_{\text{Ising}} \quad (177)$$

$$|+\rangle = |+\rangle_{\text{Ising}} \quad (178)$$

$$|-\rangle = |-\rangle_{\text{Ising}} \quad (179)$$

4.3 Compare with Exact Partition Function Calculation

We compare the boundary state result with the calculation from [3]. In this paper, it calculates the boundary states and partition function using another method. I will now compare the results in the paper to the bosonized results in this note, and show that they are consistent.

4.3.1 Boundary States

If we explicitly write down the boundary states above is of free fermion vacuum states and modes. We can have:

Fixed Boundary States:

$$|+\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|-, NS\rangle + |-, R\rangle) \quad (180)$$

$$= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \left(\prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} e^{-ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}} |0\rangle_{\text{NS}} + \sqrt[4]{2} \prod_{n \in \mathbb{N}_+} e^{-ia_{-n}\bar{a}_{-n}} |-\rangle_{\text{R}} \right) \quad (181)$$

$$= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} e^{-ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}} |0\rangle_{\text{NS}} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \prod_{n \in \mathbb{N}_+} e^{-ia_{-n}\bar{a}_{-n}} |-\rangle_{\text{R}} \quad (182)$$

$$|-\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|-, NS\rangle + |-, R\rangle) \quad (183)$$

$$= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \left(\prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} e^{-ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}} |0\rangle_{\text{NS}} - \sqrt[4]{2} \prod_{n \in \mathbb{N}_+} e^{-ia_{-n}\bar{a}_{-n}} |-\rangle_{\text{R}} \right) \quad (184)$$

$$= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} e^{-ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}} |0\rangle_{\text{NS}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \prod_{n \in \mathbb{N}_+} e^{-ia_{-n}\bar{a}_{-n}} |-\rangle_{\text{R}} \quad (185)$$

Free Boundary State:

$$|f\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} |+, NS\rangle = \prod_{k \in \mathbb{N}_+ - 1/2} e^{ia_{-k}\bar{a}_{-k}} |0\rangle_{\text{NS}} \quad (186)$$

Looking at the results of [3], we can find that the boundary states they obtain is:

$$|B_{\pm}\rangle = e^{-R\epsilon_{\lambda}} \left(\frac{\alpha}{e} \right)^{\alpha} \sqrt{\pi} \left[\frac{1}{\Gamma(\alpha + \frac{1}{2})} \exp\{i \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{n + \frac{1}{2} - \alpha}{n + \frac{1}{2} + \alpha} a_{n+1/2}^{\dagger} \bar{a}_{n+1/2}^{\dagger}\} |0\rangle \right. \quad (187)$$

$$\left. \pm \frac{2^{\frac{1}{4}} \sqrt{\alpha}}{\Gamma(\alpha + 1)} \exp\{i \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{n - \alpha}{n + \alpha} a_n^{\dagger} \bar{a}_n^{\dagger}\} |\sigma\rangle \right] \quad (188)$$

with $\epsilon_{\lambda} \sim \lambda \log \lambda^2$. Thus, we take a limit of $\alpha = 0, \lambda = 0$ then we have:

$$|B_{free}\rangle = \exp i \left\{ \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_{n+\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} \bar{a}_{n+\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} \right\} |0\rangle + i \exp i \left\{ \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_{n+\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} \bar{a}_{n+\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} \right\} a_{\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} \bar{a}_{\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} |0\rangle \quad (189)$$

which is exactly the free boundary state $|f\rangle$ we obtained above. If we take the limit of $\alpha \rightarrow \infty, \lambda \rightarrow \infty$, we have:

$$|B_{fixed\pm}\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \exp -i \left\{ \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_{n+\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} \bar{a}_{n+\frac{1}{2}}^{\dagger} \right\} (|0\rangle + |\varepsilon\rangle) \quad (190)$$

$$\pm \frac{1}{2^{\frac{1}{4}}} \exp -i \left\{ \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} a_n^{\dagger} \bar{a}_n^{\dagger} \right\} |\sigma\rangle \quad (191)$$

which is exactly the fixed boundary states $|\pm\rangle$ we obtained above. Thus we see that the boundary states obtained in [3] are exactly the same as the bosonized boundary states we obtained above.

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